"Sprout 2.0"

Part 1: The brief

Company: Sprout, a mobile investing app for first-time investors in India (start from ₹100).

Situation: Sprout has 40,000 downloads but only 9,000 completed KYC, and just 3,000 made a first investment. The homepage and the first-time app onboarding both need redesigning. Leadership wants one connected story from the website through to the first investment.

Your task: Design the homepage (mobile + desktop) and the first 5 screens of app onboarding as one continuous storytelling journey, with a mascot that works across both.

Data we have (some of it is unreliable)

Metric	Number	Note
Homepage bounce rate	78%	Measured over 2 weeks, including a paid ad campaign
Drop-off at KYC step	62%	Cause unknown
Users on mobile	91%	40% on devices under ₹10,000
Avg. load time	6.2 sec	On 4G
Users who prefer Hindi/regional content	"Many"	No exact figure
User survey (n=40)	"Investing feels scary" (65%)	All respondents were existing users

Stakeholder inputs (all real, all conflicting)

CEO: "I want it to feel like Apple: minimal, premium. No cartoon characters. Investors won't trust a cartoon."

Head of Marketing: "Our competitor's mascot got 2M Instagram views. We need a mascot, plus a video, a live ticker, 3 pop-ups, and a referral banner on the homepage."

Compliance Officer: "Every page with investment content must show a risk disclaimer in at least 12px text, visible without scrolling. Cannot say 'guaranteed', 'safe' or 'risk-free'."

Lead Developer: "Page weight must stay under 1.5 MB. Animations must be CSS or Lottie under 100 KB. We only have 1 front-end developer for 3 weeks."

Customer Support Lead: "Most complaints are 'I didn't know I needed my PAN and Aadhaar ready' and 'the app asked me to wait and I thought it crashed.'"

Constraints

- Launch in 3 weeks
- English first, Hindi must be possible later without a redesign
- Must meet basic accessibility (WCAG AA contrast, readable text, 44px tap targets)
- Brand colors are not fixed. You may propose new ones.